



"Big nosed horned face"

A new breed of dinosaur has been identified in Utah, dubbed as the Nasutoceratops Titusi. <http://digit.in/111xWOH>



Yahoo buys Ztelic

Under CEO Marissa Mayer, Yahoo acquires Chinese startup Ztelic which specialises in social network data analysis.

mation and kept distortion to a minimum. The Ixus 125 is great little cameras that does everything pretty well, but sadly, it could not maintain sharpness across the frame, with the edges becoming soft very quickly. The purple fringing was also quite pronounced when shooting against harsh contrast. In comparison, Nikon's much cheaper S5200 yielded better performance with respect to low light, colour reproduction and controlling the ugly purple fringe. The S5200, even though good on the aforementioned parameters, did lack corner sharpness, although we had to look for it at 100 per cent.

The cameras that performed very well in our real world testing were the Nikon S6500, S6400, Canon Ixus 255 HS and the Canon PowerShot SX240 HS. All four of these cameras had an exceptionally good handle on keeping purple fringing to a minimum. What

showed the best corner sharpness of all the cameras, in that it not only had minimal loss in sharpness, but also, lacked any artefact in the edges.

Now moving onto our studio test shots, we found that all these cameras maintained acceptable noise levels upto ISO 1600, but ISO 3200 and 6400 were unanimously bad enough for us to recommend never using them. However, the cameras each had a distinct noise pattern and progression. The Panasonic SZ3, though a neat little camera powered by a Leica lens, could not handle noise above ISO 3200. At this point, we started seeing pronounced red/blue dots (chroma noise) which we found difficult to treat with using noise reduction software. The same behavior also applied to the Nikon S5200, the Ixus 125 HS and somewhat to the Canon SX 240 HS as well.

As we mentioned earlier, expecting amazing perfor-



Fujifilm S4800

"true" ISO standards and 2) The performance pretty much tops out at this point. The Nikon S6500 and the Ixus 255 HS had the cleanest images of the lot, with ISO 3200 being just barely usable.

VIDEO PERFORMANCE

If you're going to have a mainstay camera, we figured that the video quality would matter just as much as the image quality. We tested the cameras in three situations; outdoor in bright daylight, indoors with regular house lighting and then in very low light (room lit by candles and outdoors after sunset). For audio, we had one of our friends sit in a room, with a window A/C on. The thing about this A/C is that it has multiple fan settings that go from 'loud as a damn jet plane' to 'silent as a ninja'. This helped us determine just how effective the microphone on the camera was in cutting out wind noise.

Outside, all cameras yielded satisfactory video quality, but the Nikons along with the Canon SX240 HS stood above the rest thanks to their ability to record 1080p video, while the

rest only shot in 720p. We particularly liked the footage out of the Canon SX240 HS, which was great partly due to the fact that we could use a larger zoom reach, but also because the stabilizer works wonderfully even at the 500mm end (although this applies only when shooting in bright daylight). Indoors, shooting at the 500mm was simply a mistake as the aperture drops to f/6.8 and the light is greatly reduced.

Indoors, we found the Nikon S6500 doing exceptionally well, mostly thanks to the f/3.1 aperture, followed closely by the SX240 HS. The noise levels remained fairly low for the most part, except in areas where shadows came into play. The noise was most prominent on skin tones and in areas that generally had red tones. The Panasonic SZ3 was particularly bad in low light, but then again, the small sensor size didn't spare anyone, not even the Nikon S6500 and the Canon SX 240 HS.

The audio levels were fairly good for voices, but only when we had the A/C down to the second quietest setting. The wind cut was barely average,



Nikon S5200

they also did well was maintain good exposure despite one of test scenes being backlit (by the sun no less). They had decent distortion control, but also managed to balance the exposure for maintaining highlight detail and shadow detail in our dynamic range test. The S6500

mance from cameras that house the smallest sensors in the category is a little unrealistic. Most cameras in this test go beyond the ISO 6400 mark, but we use that as a cap for two reasons: 1) It is the true ISO for all cameras, as the expanded ISO range isn't compliant with